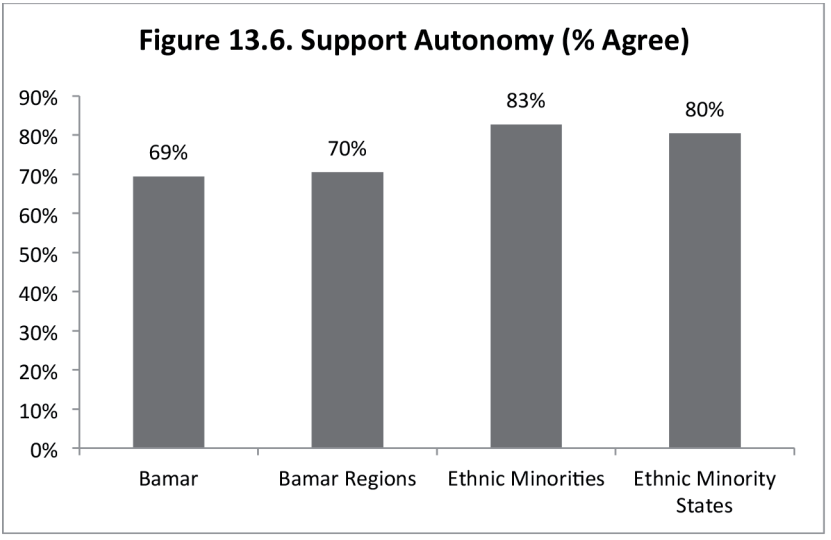
have autonomy in their states/regions." A total of sixty-nine per cent of Bamar support more autonomy for ethnic minorities, with this reaching eighty-three per cent among ethnic minorities. The ABS indicates that while there are clearly different views of the government's engagement of ethnic minorities, there is shared support for measures that have the potential to address ethnic conflict in Myanmar society.



RELIGION: IMPORTANT BUT NOT ALWAYS DIVISIVE

The picture with regard to religion is less clear-cut. Since the 2012 religious riots against Muslims in a handful of locations in Myanmar, most observers have noted that religious intolerance has increased (for example, Diamond 2014; Mufford 2014). Anti-Muslim sentiment was used to mobilize the electorate in the November 2015 elections (Perera 2015). This effort was largely unsuccessful, but the issues of religious intolerance and division remain prominent and of concern. The ABS foreshadowed the developments in the November polls, indicating that religion is one of the most serious divisions in Myanmar society, but a factor that did not necessarily detract from support for democracy and demands for better governance.

The ABS captured a low number of religious minorities in the survey,